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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1973-1975

Coverage Date: 1973-1975

Place Coverage: /Ai/Ai And Environs, Northwest Botswana

Section Title(S): Distributing Non-Food Items

Hxaro is always delayed exchange and it would be considered a serious rejection of a relationship if somebody were to return a gift immediately. A San may just wait quietly for a return or if his hxaro partner lives nearby and is a joking relative, after a respectable period of time, a minimum of two weeks, the giver [145](#) may go to the receiver and jokingly remind him that he has a debt. He will go away and return at intervals to review the debtors possessions. After a few visits, he will remark that he likes something and if the other does not indicate that it is making its way to somebody else, he will borrow it for a few days and without any verbal agreement, put a claim on it that is understood by both parties. He then will go away, drop the issue and let his partner take his time. Some of a person's possessions have a prescribed course and are not subject to such claims as they cannot be diverted without much strife.

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